Live API documentation vs the Backend Technical Specification

Checked 11 November 2026 and updated 12 November 2026. Specification: Gloxad LMS Backend Technical Specification, version 1.1. Documentation: the page at https://gloxard-backend.onrender.com/ (last modified 12 November 2026, 07:07 UTC).

1. How this was checked

- I read the documentation page and compared it with each requirement in the specification.
- I sent read-only requests to the live server to confirm that the documented routes exist. A 401 means the route exists and needs a login. A 404 means the route is not there.

2. What changed since 11 November

The documentation now covers the grading engine and the final project. The categories and providers work is live.

Spec area	Status now	Detail
Q1: 18 categories, tags, pathways, aliases, deactivate	Done	GET /api/categories returns tags, pathways, aliases and isActive. PUT /api/admin/categories/:id/status deactivates a category without deleting it.
Q2: providers and attribution	Done, registry empty	GET /api/providers, /api/providers/:idOrSlug and admin create, update and deactivate. Ownership classes: gloxad_produced, licensed_partner, externally_curated, plus an embed policy. No provider exists yet and every course has provider: null.
Q4: final project, tutor review, administrator approval	Documented	Routes for the project, stage, review, stage submit (resubmission allowed) and PUT /api/lms/final-projects/:projectId/admin-approve. Approval locks the score and unlocks programme certificate eligibility.
Q4 and Q5: grading engine and weights	Documented	Gradebook, CSV export, my-transcript, override and assessment-weights routes. Seven categories with the spec's default weights (15, 15, 15, 10, 10, 10, 25) that must total 100.
Q5: 70% certificate threshold	Documented	The gradebook and transcript return a pass flag and certificateEligibility at 70% or more.
Audit history for grade changes (spec 12.1)	Documented	GET /api/lms/cohorts/:cohortId/grade-audits lists overrides and weight changes with who changed them and the old and new values.

All eight new routes answered 401 on the live server, so they exist and are guarded.

3. Still missing or not shown

Spec requirement	Status in the docs	Detail
Q3: 22-node trail (nodeIndex 1 to 22, phase, completion criteria)	Not shown	The curriculum response is still weekly modules with lessons, a quiz and an assignment. nodeIndex does not appear in the docs. The team's summary says it was built, so an example response is needed.
Q4 and Q5: late and resubmission caps	Not shown	Weights exist. No cap policy is described.
Q6: automatic recording (processing, available, failed) and replay	Missing	Only a manually supplied recordingUrl exists. No Egress, no lifecycle states, no replay route.
Q6: YouTube Live as the secondary option	Missing	Not mentioned.
Q7: persistent workspace with cloud autosave, versions, recovery	Missing	'Workspace' in the docs means the institution workspace. There is no autosave route.
Q7: GitHub connect, push, pull, commit-based submission	Missing	GitHub appears only as a social link and in example data.
Q7: server-side code execution	Missing	Not documented. The spec requires an independent security review first.
Notifications and per-endpoint error codes	Partial	General HTTP codes are listed. The spec asks for per-endpoint error codes and event contracts.

4. Not on the live server yet

These exist in the local backend repository but return 404 on the live server and are not in the documentation:

- GET /api/lms/public/trimesters, GET /api/lms/public/trimesters/:id, POST /api/lms/trimesters/:id/enrol
- Scholarships: public list, apply, admin create and review
- Coding labs: GET /api/lms/code-labs and submissions
- Inquiries: /api/lms/inquiries
- Practice workspaces: /api/practice/workspaces

The live server serves a different LMS route design from the one the web app was built against. The plan to align them is in Gloxad-Trimester-Tasks-and-Milestones.pdf.

5. Mismatches inside the documentation itself

- The introduction says the portal documents '51 REST API endpoints and 8 Socket.io events', but the page documents far more. The count is out of date.
- Where 70% appears in the payment section it is the instructor revenue share, not the certificate threshold. The certificate threshold is documented separately in the gradebook section.